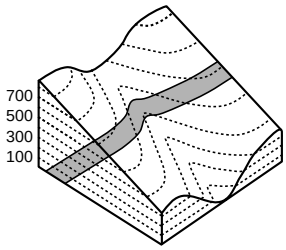
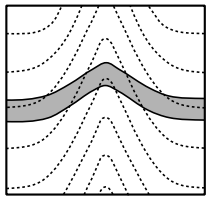
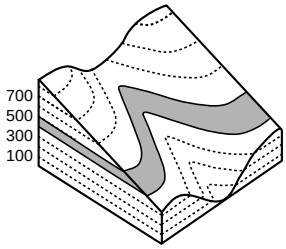
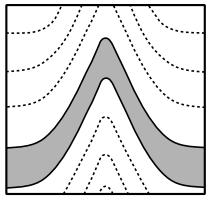
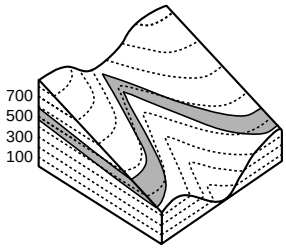
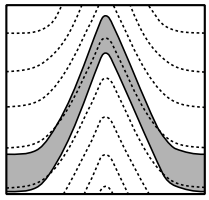
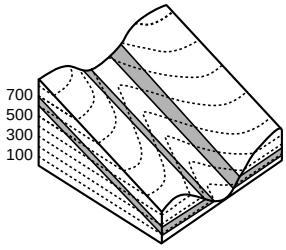
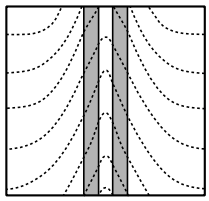
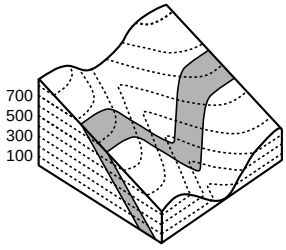
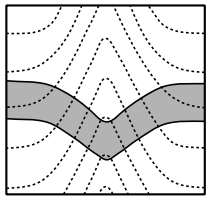
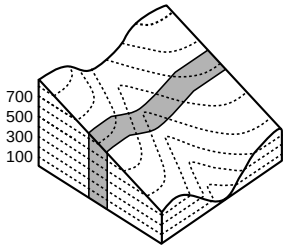
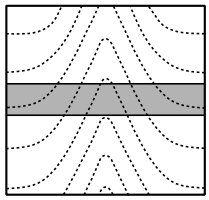
V-SHAPED OUTCROP PATTERNS

A uniformly dipping surface which crops out across a valley can give rise to a V-shaped outcrop pattern in which the V points either upstream or downstream. The direction and sharpness of the V depends upon the dip of the surface as illustrated below.

Since folding may also produce similarly shaped outcrop patterns, when locating fold axial traces on maps it is important to pay attention to this topographically produced effect.

Beds dip upstream			V points upstream blunter than contours
Beds horizontal			V points upstream parallel to contours
Beds dip gently downstream			V points upstream sharper than contours
Beds dip at stream gradient			No V shape
Beds dip steeply downstream			V points downstream
Beds vertical			No V shape